

take pride in paying the taxes. They're happy to do it. They imagine that it does some good, but they must know that its consequences are mostly malign:

- Killing people in pointless wars.
- Locking people up in the war on drugs.
- Paying bureaucrats to sit on their fat derrieres and meddle in other peoples' affairs.
- Corrupting the poor with welfare.
- Corrupting the middle class with handouts.
- Corrupting even the rich with contracts, tariffs, and special favors.

That's the difference. Give the money to your own family, and you care whether it hurts them or helps them. That's why so many people don't bother to do it, of course. They don't want to harm their own children; they'd prefer to harm someone else's.

HOW DO YOU ACCUMULATE A “FAMILY FORTUNE”?

Most people earn their money from salaries or wages. But this kind of money is unlikely to bring you much in the way of capital. You can't earn that much. And most, if not all, of what you earn will be taken up with daily expenses and retirement financing.

Unless you are an exceptional wage earner, you're not likely to be able to use your earnings to build a real family fortune. There are a lot of people in the world. When you work for wages or a salary, you are selling your time. And your time is not going to be much more valuable than another person's time.

Of course, there are exceptions. If you are a currency trader for Goldman Sachs or a celebrated brain surgeon or a football star, your time might be valuable enough to fund a family fortune. Most people, however, won't be able to do it on wages alone.

That's true for those who have their own businesses, too. If they are selling services that they provide themselves, they face the same limits as a